QNetwork Invoice System — PRD

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Overview

QNetwork will replace its email-and-Google-Sheet invoicing with a standalone web app. Employees submit one monthly invoice in the app, the CEO reviews and approves it, and each approved invoice is paid separately through Wise.

Problem today

- Invoices live in a shared Google Sheet and are sent by email, so there is no status tracking or audit trail.
- Approval reminders and the monthly email are handled outside any system of record.
- Mixed currencies (LKR and CAD) and tax are tracked by hand.

Goals

- Employees submit invoices only through the app, never by sheet link.
- Every invoice has a clear status from draft to paid, with a full history.
- The CEO reviews within a set number of days, and payment follows approval.
- Schedules, review periods, recipients and reminder content are adjustable in settings.
- Keep the CEO's work to a minimum.

Non-goals for version 1

- Sending Wise payments automatically from the app (payment is recorded, not executed).
- Payroll calculations such as statutory deductions.

Users and roles

Four roles; one person can hold more than one.

Role	Who	Can do
Employee	About 25 staff (count varies)	Create, edit, submit and track their own invoice; resubmit after rejection; mark their invoice Paid when the money arrives
Approver	CEO	Review, approve (one at a time or several at once) or reject submitted invoices; optionally mark invoices paid
Accounts	Accounting team	View all invoices, confirm payments, export records and reports
Admin	System owner (Sri Lanka)	Manage users (including setting them active or inactive), currencies, tax rates and all settings

Each user has a timezone. All times are stored in UTC and shown in the viewer's own timezone.

Invoice model

Each employee submits one invoice per month that covers everything they are owed for that month.

Line item types

Type	Example	Attachment
Professional fees	Monthly fee for services	Optional
Expense	Travel, equipment	Receipt required
App fee	Software subscriptions	Receipt or invoice required
Other	Anything else, with a description	Optional

Each line has a description, quantity, rate, tax rate and amount. Admins can add new line types.

Currency

- LKR and CAD are available at launch; admins can add more currencies (code, name, symbol, decimal places).

- An invoice uses one currency. Amounts are never converted silently.
- Exchange rates are fetched automatically every day from a rate provider. The rate on the submission date is stored with the invoice for reports in a base currency (CAD).
- At payment, the actual rate from the Wise receipt is stored as well, so reports show both the expected and the actual amount.

Tax

- Each line has a tax rate picked from an admin-managed list. The tax label is set per currency, for example VAT for LKR and GST/HST for CAD.
- Tax is calculated per line and rounded to the currency's decimal places.
- Invoices show subtotal, tax by rate, and total.
- Tax rates ship switched off until the accountant confirms them, so invoices show subtotal and total only at launch.

Numbering

Format `QN-EMP-YYYY-MM-NNN`, for example `QN-E014-2026-10-007`.

- `EMP` is the employee's unique code, set by the admin.
- `YYYY-MM` is the invoice year and month.
- `NNN` is the employee's own running number. It goes up by 1 each month and does not restart (October 007, November 008).
- The app assigns the number automatically, and it cannot be changed by anyone. Numbers never repeat or skip. Employees can add their own optional "My reference" note to any invoice.
- The format is adjustable in settings.

Invoice PDF

Sri Lankan banks often ask for these details before accepting a payment from abroad, so every invoice PDF includes:

- QNetwork's Canadian Business Number (BN) and company address, set once by the admin.
- The worker's name, address and NIC or TIN number.
- Invoice number, month, line items, subtotal, tax and total in the invoice currency.

Attachments

- PDF, JPG or PNG files, up to 10 MB each.

- Stored in private file storage, not in the database. Links are temporary and only work for signed-in users with access.

Monthly draft rules

- An employee who joins mid-month gets a draft for that month, and the professional fees line can be adjusted for the part month.
- Only one invoice exists per employee per month. A rejected invoice stays in its original month, even if it is fixed after the month ends, so no duplicate draft is created.

Employee flow

Invoices are submitted only through the app. Sheet links are not accepted.

1. Log in to the app.
2. Open the current month's invoice. The app creates a draft automatically at the start of each month, with the employee's usual currency and professional fees line pre-filled.
3. Add line items during the month as they happen, attaching receipts for expenses and app fees.
4. Check every line and total, tick "I confirm everything is correct", then submit on any date that suits them. Nothing is sent to the CEO until the employee confirms. Submission dates differ by employee.
5. Track the status: Draft, Submitted, Approved, Paid, or Rejected.
6. If rejected, read the CEO's comment, fix the invoice and resubmit. The review period restarts from the resubmission date.
7. Receive an email at each status change. When the money arrives, mark the invoice Paid and, optionally, enter the amount received. If the CEO has already marked it Paid, no action is needed.

Rules

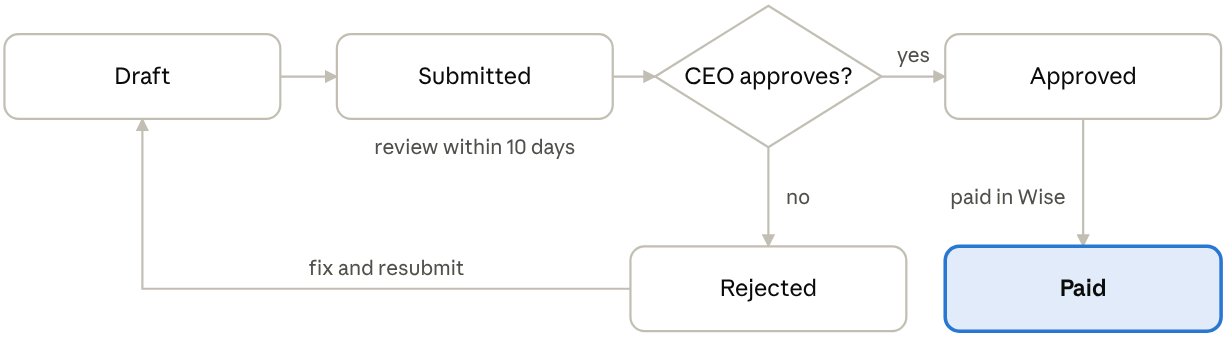
- One invoice per employee per month.
- An employee can recall a submitted invoice back to draft until the CEO opens it. Once the CEO starts reviewing, the invoice is locked. A recalled invoice's review period restarts when it is resubmitted.
- Required receipts must be attached before submission.
- Only active employees can submit. When an employee leaves, an admin switches them to Inactive: they can no longer log in, no new monthly drafts are created for them, and their past invoices stay in the records. An invoice they had already submitted can still

be approved and paid.

Approval and payment flow

Each invoice is reviewed and paid on its own. The CEO has 10 days from submission to review (adjustable), and payment follows approval straight away.

Each approved invoice is paid on its own, straight away



invoice approval and payment flow

A rejected invoice goes back to the employee, and its review period restarts on resubmission.

CEO (approver)

The CEO's work is kept to a minimum: one daily email, approving several invoices in one click, and no need to mark payments, since employees can do that themselves.

1. Gets one summary email each morning listing every invoice not yet marked Paid, with overdue ones at the top, plus a warning when an invoice nears its review deadline. No email is sent when everything is paid.
2. Opens the waiting invoices from the email. The CEO can review and approve them one at a time, or tick several and approve them together in one click.
3. Rejects an invoice with a comment if something needs fixing.
4. Pays approved invoices in Wise. Marking them Paid in the app is optional for the CEO: they can mark several Paid at once, or leave it to each employee to mark their own invoice Paid when the money arrives.

Accounts

- Sees every invoice and its status on a dashboard, filterable by employee, month, currency and status.
- Sees which invoices were marked Paid and by whom (CEO or employee), confirms them against Wise records, and exports reports to CSV or the Google Sheet backup.

Timeline example

Event	Date
Employee submits	15th
Review deadline (submission + 10 days)	25th
Payment	Same day as approval, no later than the 25th

Wise fees

Who pays Wise's transfer and conversion fees is an admin setting:

- **Company pays:** the employee receives the full invoice amount.
- **Deducted:** the fees come out of the payment, and the employee receives the invoice amount minus the fees.

Either way, each payment records the amount sent, the fee, the amount received and the actual exchange rate.

Notifications and reminders

All emails are sent by the app, and every send is logged.

Email	Sent to	When
Daily approval summary	CEO	Once each morning (time adjustable). Lists every invoice not yet marked Paid: overdue ones at the top, then those waiting for approval, then approved ones waiting for payment. Each invoice stays in the summary until its status is Paid. Not sent when every invoice is paid.
Review deadline warning	CEO	24 hours before an invoice's review deadline

Email	Sent to	When
Overdue alert	Accounts	Once, when the review deadline passes without approval. The CEO gets no separate email; the invoice shows as Overdue at the top of the daily summary instead.
Status update	Employee	On approval, on rejection, and when the CEO marks it paid
Monthly summary	CEO, accounts	15th at 6:30 PM Sri Lanka time (adjustable)

Monthly summary email

- Lists every invoice for the month with employee, number, currency, total and status.
- Highlights invoices still waiting for approval or payment.
- Links to each invoice and attaches PDFs.
- Replaces the current monthly email sent from the Google Sheet.

Reminder content

The daily summary shows invoice number, date, total and status for each invoice not yet marked Paid. Which fields appear is adjustable in settings. An invoice drops off the summary as soon as the CEO or the employee marks it Paid, so if the CEO has paid in Wise but the employee hasn't confirmed yet, the CEO can mark it Paid to clear it. There is no separate email per submission or per overdue invoice, so the CEO gets at most one summary a day plus any deadline warnings. If every invoice is paid, no email is sent.

Admin settings

Every value below is adjustable by an admin. When a setting is changed, the last-used value is kept as the default next time.

Setting	Default
Review period after submission	10 days
Monthly summary email day and time	15th, 6:30 PM Sri Lanka time
Monthly summary and reminder recipients	CEO and accounts

Setting	Default
Daily summary time	8:00 AM in the CEO's timezone
Reminder fields	Invoice number, date, total
Invoice number format	`QN-EMP-YYYY-MM-NNN`
Currencies	LKR, CAD
Base currency for reports	CAD
Tax rates and labels	Defined but switched off
Line item types	Professional fees, Expense, App fee, Other
Email wording	Default templates

Admins also manage users, roles and each employee's default currency.

Admins also set who pays Wise fees (company or deducted from the payment) and the company details printed on every invoice PDF: Business Number and address.

Data model

Entity	Key fields
User	Name, employee code, status (active or inactive), NIC or TIN, address, email, role(s), timezone, default currency, Wise recipient reference
Invoice	Number (system-generated, cannot be edited), employee reference, employee, month, currency, status, subtotal, tax total, total, exchange rate to base, employee confirmed at, submitted at, recalled at, review started at, review deadline, approved at, paid at, marked paid by (CEO or employee)
LineItem	Invoice, type, description, quantity, rate, tax rate, tax amount, line total, attachments (in private file storage)
LineType	Name, receipt required, default tax rate, active

Entity	Key fields
Currency	Code, name, symbol, decimal places, active
TaxRate	Name, percentage, label, currency, active
ExchangeRate	Date, from currency, to currency, rate, source
Payment	Invoice, Wise transfer ID, amount sent, sent currency, Wise fee, fee paid by, amount received, received currency, actual exchange rate, paid at, recorded by
ApprovalEvent	Invoice, actor, action, previous status, new status, comment, system note, IP address, browser, timestamp (audit trail)
Setting	Key, value, updated by, updated at
NotificationLog	Type, recipient, invoice, sent at, status

Technical requirements

Non-functional

- Secure login with email link or password; two-factor for approver, accounts and admin.
- Role-based access: employees see only their own invoices.
- Every change to an invoice is recorded in the audit trail.
- Receipts and PDFs stored securely, with daily backups.
- Works on phone and desktop browsers.
- Built for about 25 invoices a month, with room to grow without changes.

Suggested stack

- Web app with a relational database.
- A background scheduler for reminders, deadlines, daily exchange-rate fetches and the monthly email.
- A transactional email service for all notifications.
- PDF generation for invoices.
- An exchange-rate provider that covers LKR and CAD.
- Optional later: the Wise API to send payments directly from the app.

Rollout, assumptions and open items

Rollout

1. Build and test with the admin, CEO and two or three employees.
2. Go live for all employees; the Google Sheet stays as a read-only backup, with approved invoices exported to it.
3. After a few months of matching records, retire the sheet.

Assumptions

- The review deadline is counted from each invoice's own submission date, so the fixed monthly payment cutoff day is dropped.
- Payment happens as soon as the CEO approves, so the payment deadline equals the review deadline.
- The CEO gets one daily summary of every invoice not yet paid, instead of an email per invoice, alongside the monthly summary.
- The CEO pays in Wise. Either the CEO or the employee can mark an invoice Paid; the app does not move money in version 1.

Open items

- [ ] Accountant confirms which tax rates apply to LKR and CAD invoices, and whether QNetwork must charge VAT or GST.
- [ ] Choose the exchange-rate provider.
- [x] ~~Confirm the `QN-EMP-YYYY-MM-NNN` invoice number format.~~
- [x] ~~Decide what happens to invoices still unapproved after the review deadline: they stay at the top of the CEO's daily summary as Overdue, and accounts gets one alert.~~
- [ ] Accountant confirms that workers are treated as contractors and that "Professional fees" is the right label.
- [ ] Choose the default for who pays Wise fees before launch.